

Grade 6 practice paper 1

Time allowed: 3 hours · 100 marks · pass 66, merit 80, distinction 90

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 100

Our own paper in the style of the ABRSM Grade 6 exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Suggested timing: questions 1 and 2, 25 minutes each (in question 1 you may write in four parts or keyboard style; this paper practises four parts); question 3, 35 minutes; questions 4 and 5, 35 minutes each; 25 minutes to check.

Question 1: Figured bass (15 marks)

15 marks

1. Realise this figured bass: add soprano, alto and tenor. (D minor)

6/5 6/5 7#

Question 2: Chords for a melody (15 marks)

15 marks

2. Choose a chord for each beat, ending with a plagal cadence. (E $\flat$ major)

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8

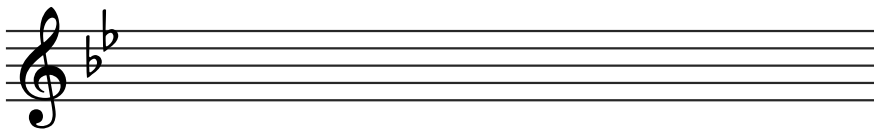
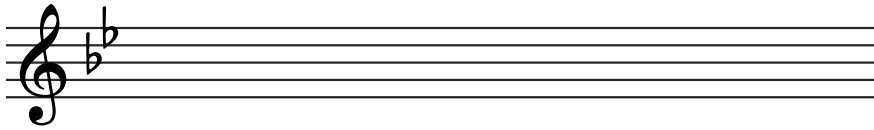
Chords: 1 ____ 2 ____ 3 ____ 4 ____ 5 ____ 6 ____ 7 ____ 8 ____

Or write a bass line with figures on the stave above.

Question 3: Composition (20 marks)

20 marks

3. Composition: Continue this opening for oboe to make a melody of 8 bars. It may modulate to the relative major (B $\flat$ major) or the dominant minor (D minor), then return to G minor. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance directions.



oboe range: B $\flat$ 3 to about F6.

Question 4: Questions on a score (25 marks)

3 marks

4. This string quartet extract is in F minor. Name the chord at X.

Larghetto

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

p *pp*

p *pp*

p *pp*

pizz. *arco*

p *pp*

- A. IVb B. Vc C. II7b D. Vb

3 marks

5. At X, which note of the chord does the Cello play?

Lento

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

A. root

B. 7th

C. 3rd

D. 5th

3 marks

6. Which figures go under this chord? (Key: A minor)

A. 6

B. #6/4/3

C. #6/4

D. 5/3 (no figure)

3 marks

7. Name the cadence at the end of this passage in A $\flat$ major.

A. perfect

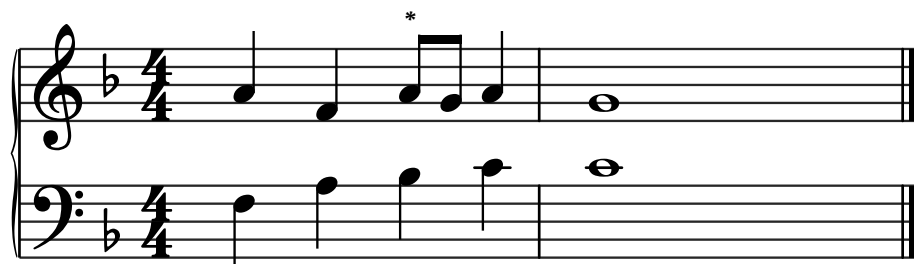
B. interrupted

C. plagal

D. imperfect

3 marks

8. The note marked * is which kind of note? (F major)



A. changing notes

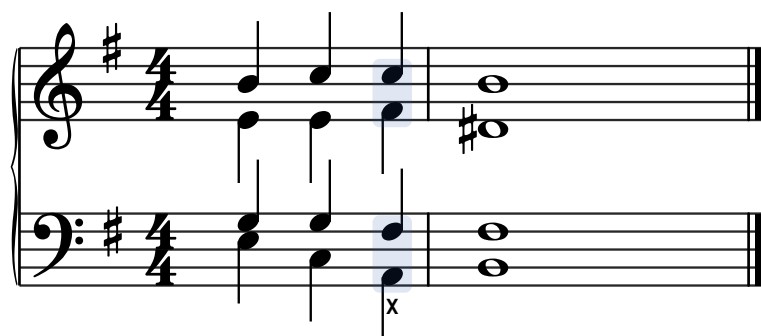
B. appoggiatura

C. suspension

D. auxiliary note

3 marks

9. Name the interval between the bass and alto in the chord marked X.



A. diminished 14th

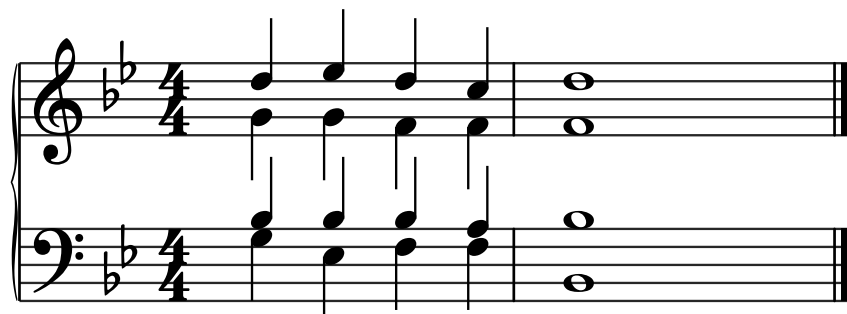
B. diminished 13th

C. minor 14th

D. major 13th

3 marks

10. This passage starts in G minor. Which key does it end in?



A. D minor

B. C minor

C. G minor

D. Bb major

4 marks

11. Name the interval between the cello and violin I at X (the first note of violin I there).

Allegretto

The musical score is for an orchestral piece in 4/4 time, key of A major (three sharps). It features four staves: Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. The tempo is marked *Allegretto*. The dynamics are *f* (forte) and *mf* (mezzo-forte). The interval between the Cello and Violin I at measure 4 is marked with an 'X'.

Measure	Violin I	Violin II	Viola	Cello
1	A4 (quarter)	A3 (quarter)	A3 (quarter)	A2 (quarter)
2	B4 (quarter)	B3 (quarter)	B3 (quarter)	B2 (quarter)
3	C5 (quarter)	C4 (quarter)	C4 (quarter)	C3 (quarter)
4	D5 (quarter)	D4 (quarter)	D4 (quarter)	D3 (quarter)

A. augmented 10th

B. minor 10th

C. perfect 11th

D. major 10th

Question 5: An orchestral score and general questions (25 marks)

3 marks

12. Which instruments play the bass line together?

The musical score is for a 4/4 piece in B-flat major. The instruments and their parts are as follows:

- Flute:** Treble clef, 4/4 time. Notes: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (half).
- Clarinet in B $\flat$:** Treble clef, 4/4 time. Notes: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (half).
- Horn in F:** Treble clef, 4/4 time. Notes: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (half).
- Bassoon:** Bass clef, 4/4 time. Notes: G3 (quarter), A3 (quarter), B3 (quarter), C4 (quarter), B3 (quarter), A3 (quarter), G3 (half).
- Violin I:** Treble clef, 4/4 time. Notes: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (half).
- Violin II:** Treble clef, 4/4 time. Notes: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (half).
- Viola:** Alto clef, 4/4 time. Notes: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (half).
- Cello:** Bass clef, 4/4 time. Notes: G3 (quarter), A3 (quarter), B3 (quarter), C4 (quarter), B3 (quarter), A3 (quarter), G3 (half).

The bass line is played by the Bassoon, Viola, and Cello, all of which play the same notes in the bass register.

A. bassoon and cello

B. bassoon and viola

C. horn and cello

D. viola and cello

3 marks

13. Which instruments play the bass line together?

The musical score is for an orchestra in 4/4 time, key of D major (two sharps). The instruments listed are Flute, Clarinet in B $\flat$, Horn in F, Bassoon, Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. The bass line is played by the Bassoon, Viola, and Cello. The melody is played by the Flute, Clarinet in B $\flat$, Horn in F, Violin I, Violin II, and Viola. The key signature is D major (two sharps). The time signature is 4/4. The bass line consists of a series of eighth notes: D2, E2, F#2, G2, A2, B2, followed by a whole note D2.

A. bassoon and cello

B. bassoon and viola

C. horn and cello

D. viola and cello

3 marks

14. Which note actually sounds for the horn in F at Y?

The musical score shows eight staves. The Horn in F staff has a note marked with a 'Y' on the second staff, which is a G4 note (one line below the staff).

A. B

B. E

C. G

D. F

3 marks

15. The trumpet in B $\flat$ plays this written note. Which note actually sounds?

A. G

B. G $\sharp$

C. F

D. A

3 marks

16. In a full orchestral score, which of these is written lower down the page?

A. viola

B. timpani

3 marks

17. What does this mean?

slentando

A. getting slower

B. mute

C. both players play the same part

D. at the first speed

3 marks

18. The note marked * in violin I is which kind of note?

Maestoso

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

mp *p*

mp *p*

mp *p*

mp *p*

A. changing note

B. passing note

C. anticipation

D. auxiliary note

4 marks

19. The note marked * is which kind of note? (D major)

mp *p*

A. suspension

B. changing notes

C. auxiliary note

D. passing note

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. Q1 · 15m **Model answer below (other good answers are possible): I - V7b - I - V7b - I - V7 - I.**

I V7b I V7b I V7 I

Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each real mistake (a wrong chord or note, a missing 3rd, consecutive 5ths or octaves, a doubled leading note, an unresolved 7th or leading note). Take off 1 for weaker points (an awkward leap, a doubled 3rd).

2. Q2 · 15m **One good answer: I - IVb - V - I - Vb - I - IV - I.**

I IVb V I Vb I IV I

Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each real mistake (a wrong chord or note, a missing 3rd, consecutive 5ths or octaves, a doubled leading note, an unresolved 7th or leading note). Take off 1 for weaker points (an awkward leap, a doubled 3rd).

3. Q3 · 20m **Mark with the checklist (10 points × 2 marks).**

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps
6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

One model answer:

Andantino



1. Bars 3–4 climb by step and hold D, the dominant, on the downbeat: an imperfect cadence.
2. Bars 5–6 use F# (no F#) and rise to Bb on the downbeat of bar 6: the relative major, and the high point.
3. Bar 7 brings back F# to return to G minor.
4. Bar 8: G, the tonic.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (Andantino), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the oboe.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4. Q4 · 3m **D: Vb.** At X the four instruments play E, G, C, G (cello upwards): C–E–G with E in the bass, so Vb.
5. Q4 · 3m **A: root.** The chord at X is II (D–F–A). The Cello plays D, the root.
6. Q4 · 3m **B: #6/4/3.** The chord is V7c (E–G#–B–D) with B in the bass. Count up from the bass: #6/4/3.
7. Q4 · 3m **C: plagal.** The last two chords are IV and I: IV–I is a plagal cadence.
8. Q4 · 3m **B: appoggiatura.** An appoggiatura leans on the beat: it's a clash on the strong part of the beat that then falls (or rises) by step to the chord note.
9. Q4 · 3m **D: major 13th.** A up to F# is a major 13th (a compound major 6th: 13 letters counting both ends).
10. Q4 · 3m **D: Bb major.** It ends with a perfect cadence in Bb major: F–A–C then Bb–D–F. Look for the new accidental: A is the new key's leading note.
11. Q4 · 4m **D: major 10th.** Cello B up to violin I D#: a major 10th.
12. Q5 · 3m **A: bassoon and cello.** The bassoon and cello have the same notes: the bass line.
13. Q5 · 3m **A: bassoon and cello.** The bassoon and cello have the same notes: the bass line.

14. Q5 · 3m **C: G**. A horn in F sounds a perfect 5th lower than written (horn parts are often written without a key signature). Its written note at Y sounds as G, the same note the viola has.
15. Q5 · 3m **A: G**. The trumpet in B $\flat$ sounds a major 2nd lower than written, so go DOWN a major 2nd: A sounds as G.
16. Q5 · 3m **A: viola**. Score order from the top: woodwind (flute, oboe, clarinet, bassoon), brass (horn, trumpet, trombone, tuba), percussion (timpani first), then strings (violin I, violin II, viola, cello, double bass). So timpani comes above viola.
17. Q5 · 3m **A: getting slower**. *slentando* is Italian for "getting slower".
18. Q5 · 3m **B: passing note**. It fills the gap between two chord notes a 3rd apart, by step.
19. Q5 · 4m **C: auxiliary note**. An auxiliary note steps away from a chord note and comes straight back to it.

Grade 6 practice paper 2

Time allowed: 3 hours · 100 marks · pass 66, merit 80, distinction 90

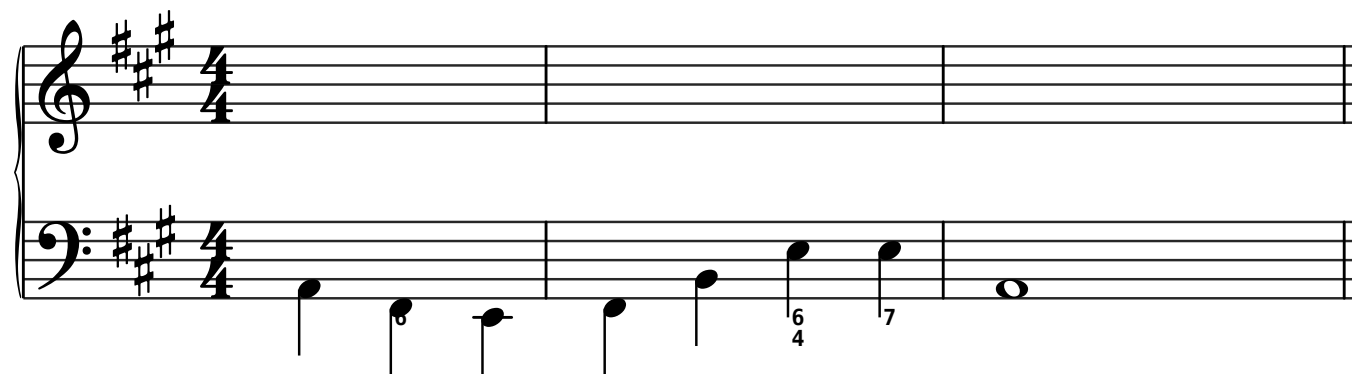
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Question 1: Figured bass (15 marks)

15 marks

1. Realise this figured bass: add soprano, alto and tenor. (A major)



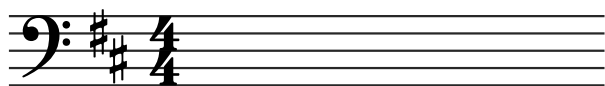
Question 2: Chords for a melody (15 marks)

15 marks

2. Choose a chord for each beat, ending with a plagal cadence. (B minor)



Chords: 1 ____ 2 ____ 3 ____ 4 ____ 5 ____ 6 ____ 7 ____ 8 ____

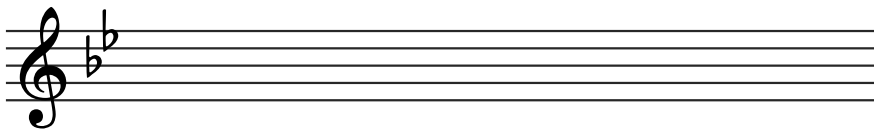
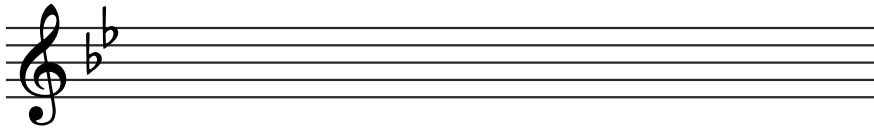


Or write a bass line with figures on the stave above.

Question 3: Composition (20 marks)

20 marks

3. Composition: Continue this opening for flute to make a melody of 8 bars. It should modulate to the dominant (F major), then return to B $\flat$ major. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance directions.



flute range: C4 to about C7.

Question 4: Questions on a score (25 marks)

3 marks

4. At X, which note of the chord does the Viola play?

Maestoso

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

mf

mf

mf

mf

f

f

f

f

pizz.

arco

X

A. 7th

B. 3rd

C. root

D. 5th

3 marks

5. This string quartet extract is in E minor. Name the chord at X.

Moderato

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

f *ff*

f *ff*

pizz. *arco*

A. IVb

B. Ib

C. V

D. IVc

3 marks

6. In E minor, which chord does this bass note and figure show?

6

A. II7b

B. Ic

C. IVb

D. VIIb

3 marks

7. Name the cadence at the end of this passage in E $\flat$ major.

4/4

A. plagal

B. interrupted

C. perfect

D. imperfect

3 marks

8. The note marked * is which kind of note? (C minor)



A. suspension

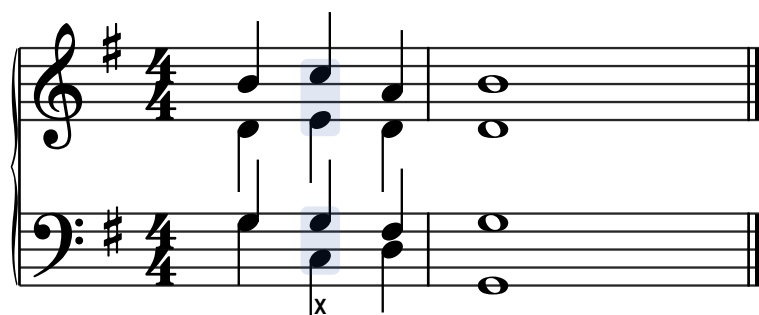
B. auxiliary note

C. appoggiatura

D. anticipation

3 marks

9. Name the interval between the bass and alto in the chord marked X.



A. major 10th

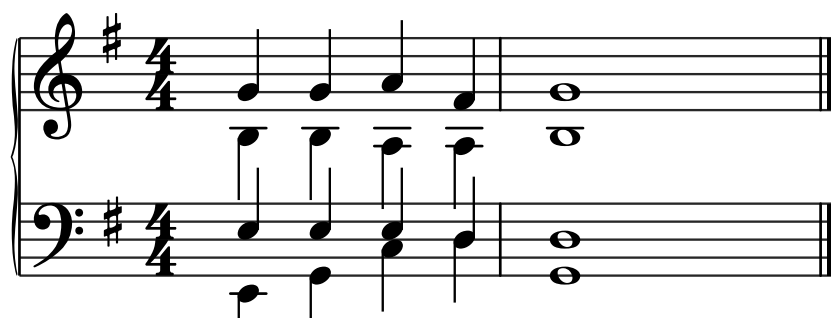
B. augmented 10th

C. diminished 9th

D. diminished 10th

3 marks

10. This passage starts in E minor. Which key does it end in?



A. G major

B. E minor

C. A minor

D. B minor

4 marks

11. This string quartet extract is in B minor. Name the chord at X.

Allegro ma non troppo

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

A. I

B. Ib

C. VI

D. V7b

Question 5: An orchestral score and general questions (25 marks)

3 marks

12. The clarinet in B $\flat$ plays the note marked X. Which note actually sounds?

The musical score shows the following parts:

- Flute:** Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), 4/4 time. Notes: D4, E4, F#4, G4, A4, B4, D5 (whole note).
- Clarinet in B $\flat$:** Treble clef, key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#), 4/4 time. Notes: D4, E4, **X** (F#4), G4, A4, B4, D5 (whole note).
- Horn in F:** Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), 4/4 time. Notes: D4, E4, F#4, G4, A4, B4, D5 (whole note).
- Bassoon:** Bass clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), 4/4 time. Notes: D3, E3, F#3, G3, A3, B3, D4 (whole note).
- Violin I:** Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), 4/4 time. Notes: D4, E4, F#4, G4, A4, B4, D5 (whole note).
- Violin II:** Treble clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), 4/4 time. Notes: D4, E4, F#4, G4, A4, B4, D5 (whole note).
- Viola:** Alto clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), 4/4 time. Notes: D4, E4, F#4, G4, A4, B4, D5 (whole note).
- Cello:** Bass clef, key signature of one sharp (F#), 4/4 time. Notes: D3, E3, F#3, G3, A3, B3, D4 (whole note).

A. G

B. F $\sharp$

C. A

D. E

3 marks

13. Which instrument doubles violin I an octave higher?

The musical score is for an orchestra in D major (two sharps) and 4/4 time. It consists of eight staves, each labeled with an instrument name on the left. The instruments are: Flute, Clarinet in B $\flat$, Horn in F, Bassoon, Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. The Flute part is written on a treble clef staff and is an octave higher than the Violin I part. The Clarinet in B $\flat$, Horn in F, Bassoon, Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello parts are all written on staves that are an octave lower than the Flute part. The Flute part is the only one that is an octave higher than the Violin I part.

A. clarinet in B $\flat$

B. flute

C. violin II

D. horn in F

3 marks

14. Which instrument doubles violin I an octave higher?

The musical score shows the following parts:

- Flute:** Treble clef, 4/4 time, key of D major. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (half).
- Clarinet in Bb:** Treble clef, 4/4 time, key of D major. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (half).
- Horn in F:** Treble clef, 4/4 time, key of D major. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (half).
- Bassoon:** Bass clef, 4/4 time, key of D major. Notes: D3 (quarter), E3 (quarter), F#3 (quarter), G3 (quarter), A3 (half).
- Violin I:** Treble clef, 4/4 time, key of D major. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (half).
- Violin II:** Treble clef, 4/4 time, key of D major. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (half).
- Viola:** Alto clef, 4/4 time, key of D major. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (half).
- Cello:** Bass clef, 4/4 time, key of D major. Notes: D3 (quarter), E3 (quarter), F#3 (quarter), G3 (quarter), A3 (half).

A. horn in F

B. flute

C. bassoon

D. clarinet in Bb

3 marks

15. How does the clarinet in A sound, compared with its written notes?

A. exactly as written

B. a major 2nd lower

C. a minor 3rd lower

D. an octave lower

3 marks

16. How does the cor anglais sound, compared with its written notes?

A. a perfect 5th lower

B. a major 2nd lower

C. an octave lower

D. a minor 3rd lower

3 marks

17. Which German word means "lively"?

A. furioso

B. lebhaft

C. giocoso

D. meno

3 marks

18. The note marked * in violin I is which kind of note?

Lento

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

A. auxiliary note

B. appoggiatura

C. passing note

D. suspension

4 marks

19. The note marked * is which kind of note? (C major)

A. changing notes

B. anticipation

C. auxiliary note

D. appoggiatura

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. Q1 · 15m **Model answer below (other good answers are possible): I - IVb - V - VI - II - Ic - V7 - I.**

I IVb V VI II Ic V7 I

Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each real mistake (a wrong chord or note, a missing 3rd, consecutive 5ths or octaves, a doubled leading note, an unresolved 7th or leading note). Take off 1 for weaker points (an awkward leap, a doubled 3rd).

2. Q2 · 15m **One good answer: I - V - VI - V - I - VI - IV - I.**

I V VI V I VI IV I

Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each real mistake (a wrong chord or note, a missing 3rd, consecutive 5ths or octaves, a doubled leading note, an unresolved 7th or leading note). Take off 1 for weaker points (an awkward leap, a doubled 3rd).

3. Q3 · 20m **Mark with the checklist (10 points × 2 marks).**

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps
6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

One model answer:

Allegro moderato



1. Bar 3 is a sequence of bar 1, a step higher; bar 4 holds F, the dominant.
2. Bar 5 climbs to the high B $\flat$ and uses E $\natural$, the leading note of F major, so bar 6 cadences in the dominant.
3. Bar 7 brings back E $\flat$ and steps down home.
4. Bar 8: B $\flat$, the tonic.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (*Allegro moderato*), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the flute.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4. Q4 · 3m **D: 5th.** The chord at X is Ic (E-G-B). The Viola plays B, the 5th.
5. Q4 · 3m **A: IVb.** At X the four instruments play C, A, E, A (cello upwards): A-C-E with C in the bass, so IVb.
6. Q4 · 3m **C: IVb.** C with "6" is IVb: A-C-E.
7. Q4 · 3m **C: perfect.** The last two chords are V and I: V-I is a perfect cadence.
8. Q4 · 3m **D: anticipation.** An anticipation sounds a note of the NEXT chord early, before the chord changes.
9. Q4 · 3m **A: major 10th.** C up to E is a major 10th (a compound major 3rd: 10 letters counting both ends).
10. Q4 · 3m **A: G major.** It ends with a perfect cadence in G major: D-F $\sharp$ -A then G-B-D. Look for the new accidental: F $\sharp$ is the new key's leading note.
11. Q4 · 4m **A: I.** At X the four instruments play B, B, D, F $\sharp$ (cello upwards): B-D-F $\sharp$ with B in the bass, so I.
12. Q5 · 3m **A: G.** A B $\flat$ clarinet sounds a major 2nd (a tone) lower than written: written A sounds as G, the same note as violin II.
13. Q5 · 3m **B: flute.** The flute plays the violin I tune an octave higher all the way through.
14. Q5 · 3m **B: flute.** The flute plays the violin I tune an octave higher all the way through.

15. Q5 · 3m **C: a minor 3rd lower.** The clarinet in A sounds a minor 3rd lower than written.
16. Q5 · 3m **A: a perfect 5th lower.** The cor anglais sounds a perfect 5th lower than written.
17. Q5 · 3m **B: lebhaft.** lebhaft is German for "lively".
18. Q5 · 3m **A: auxiliary note.** It steps away from a chord note and comes straight back.
19. Q5 · 4m **C: auxiliary note.** An auxiliary note steps away from a chord note and comes straight back to it.

Grade 6 practice paper 3

Time allowed: 3 hours · 100 marks · pass 66, merit 80, distinction 90

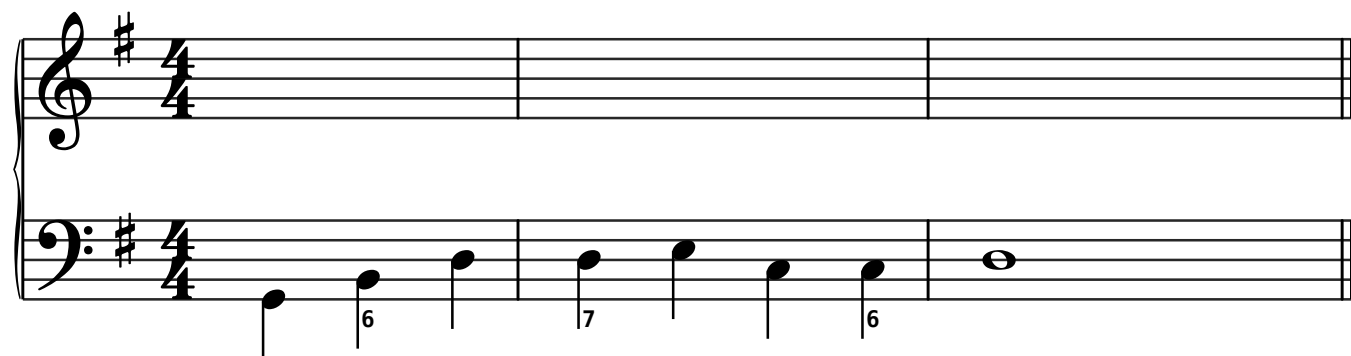
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Question 1: Figured bass (15 marks)

15 marks

1. Realise this figured bass: add soprano, alto and tenor. (G major)



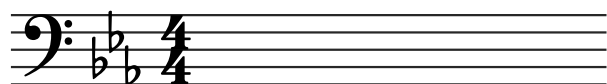
Question 2: Chords for a melody (15 marks)

15 marks

2. Choose a chord for each beat, ending with an interrupted cadence. (E $\flat$ major)



Chords: 1 ____ 2 ____ 3 ____ 4 ____ 5 ____ 6 ____ 7 ____ 8 ____

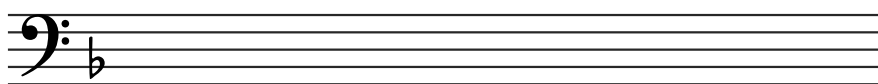
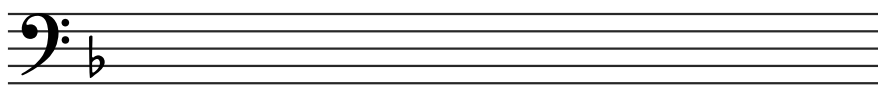


Or write a bass line with figures on the stave above.

Question 3: Composition (20 marks)

20 marks

3. Composition: Continue this opening for cello to make a melody of 8 bars. It may modulate to the relative major (F major) or the dominant minor (A minor), then return to D minor. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance directions.



cello range: C2 upwards (tenor clef for high notes).

Question 4: Questions on a score (25 marks)

3 marks

4. At X, which note of the chord does the Violin I play?

Allegretto

A. root

B. 3rd

C. 7th

D. 5th

3 marks

5. Name the viola's note at Y. (The viola reads alto clef.)

Adagio

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

mf *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp* *mf* *pp*

pizz. *arco*

A. G

B. E $\flat$

C. C

D. F

3 marks

6. In F $\sharp$ minor, which chord does this bass note and figure show?

7 $\sharp$

A. IVc

B. I

C. VIIb

D. V7

3 marks

7. Name the cadence at the end of this passage in F $\sharp$ minor.

4/4

A. interrupted

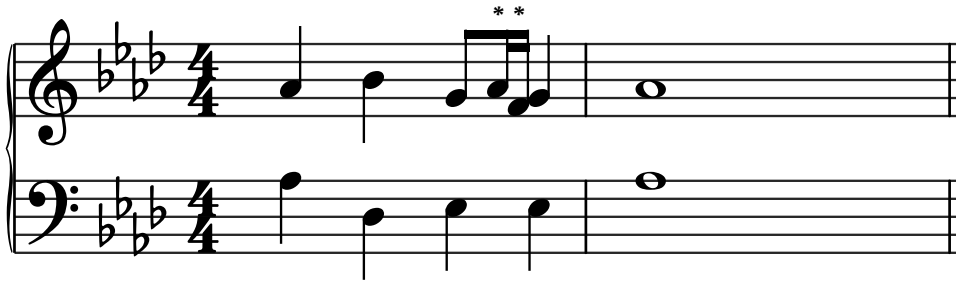
B. imperfect

C. plagal

D. perfect

3 marks

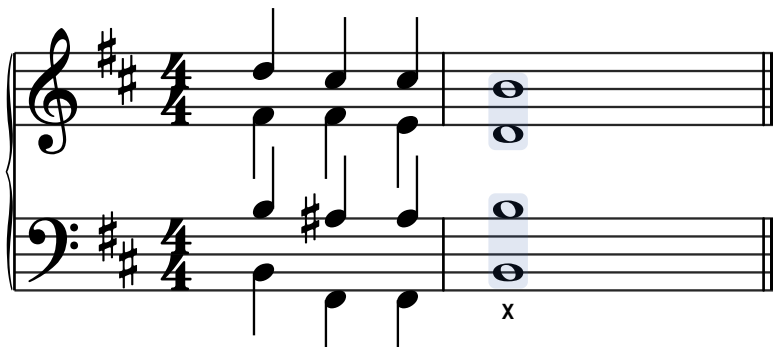
8. The two notes marked * are which kind of note? (A $\flat$ major)



- A. passing note B. anticipation C. changing notes D. appoggiatura

3 marks

9. Name the interval between the bass and soprano in the chord marked X.



- A. minor 16th B. diminished 15th C. perfect 15th D. augmented 16th

3 marks

10. What is the subdominant key of G major?

- A. D $\flat$ major B. A minor C. F $\sharp$ minor D. C major

4 marks

11. How does the dynamic change at D?

Adagio

- A. it stays the same B. it gets quieter (mf to pp) C. it gradually gets louder D. it gets louder (mf to pp)

Question 5: An orchestral score and general questions (25 marks)

3 marks

12. Why does the clarinet part have a different key signature from the strings?

The image shows a snippet of an orchestral score with eight staves. The instruments are listed on the left: Flute, Clarinet in B $\flat$, Horn in F, Bassoon, Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. The key signature for all parts is one flat (B $\flat$). The time signature is 4/4. The Flute part has a key signature of two flats (B $\flat$ and E $\flat$). The Clarinet in B $\flat$ part has a key signature of one flat (B $\flat$). The Horn in F part has a key signature of two flats (B $\flat$ and E $\flat$). The Bassoon part has a key signature of one flat (B $\flat$). The Violin I and Violin II parts have a key signature of one flat (B $\flat$). The Viola part has a key signature of one flat (B $\flat$). The Cello part has a key signature of one flat (B $\flat$).

- A. the clarinet reads alto clef B. it's a B $\flat$ instrument, so it's written a tone higher C. it plays in a different key on purpose D. it sounds a tone higher than written

3 marks

13. The clarinet in B $\flat$ plays the note marked X. Which note actually sounds?

The musical score shows eight staves for the following instruments: Flute, Clarinet in B $\flat$, Horn in F, Bassoon, Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. All are in 4/4 time with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The Clarinet in B $\flat$ staff has a note marked with an 'X' on the second line, which is a written G4. The other instruments play a sequence of notes: D4, E4, F#4, G4, and A4.

A. A

B. F#

C. E

D. G

3 marks

14. The clarinet in B $\flat$ plays the note marked X. Which note actually sounds?

Flute

Clarinet in B $\flat$

Horn in F

Bassoon

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

A. A

B. D

C. E $\flat$

D. F

3 marks

15. How does the trumpet in B $\flat$ sound, compared with its written notes?

A. exactly as written

B. an octave lower

C. a minor 3rd lower

D. a major 2nd lower

3 marks

16. The horn in F plays this written note. Which note actually sounds?

A. F $\flat$

B. F

C. C

D. E

3 marks

17. What does this mean?

veloce

A. swiftly

B. always

C. passionately

D. at a walking pace

3 marks

18. At X, which note of the chord does the Violin II play?

Andante

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

mf *ff* *tr*

mf *ff* *mf* *ff*

mf *ff*

mf *ff*

X

A. 7th

B. 3rd

C. 5th

D. root

4 marks

19. The note marked * is which kind of note? (D minor)

*

A. changing notes

B. auxiliary note

C. anticipation

D. suspension

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. Q1 · 15m **Model answer below (other good answers are possible): I - Ib - V - V7 - VI - IV - IIb - V.**

I Ib V V7 VI IV IIb V

Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each real mistake (a wrong chord or note, a missing 3rd, consecutive 5ths or octaves, a doubled leading note, an unresolved 7th or leading note). Take off 1 for weaker points (an awkward leap, a doubled 3rd).

2. Q2 · 15m **One good answer: I - II - V7 - VI - II - V7 - VI.**

I II V7 VI II V7 VI

Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each real mistake (a wrong chord or note, a missing 3rd, consecutive 5ths or octaves, a doubled leading note, an unresolved 7th or leading note). Take off 1 for weaker points (an awkward leap, a doubled 3rd).

3. Q3 · 20m **Mark with the checklist (10 points × 2 marks).**

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps
6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

One model answer:

Andante espressivo



1. Bars 3–4 rise to C#, the leading note, held over chord V: an imperfect cadence.
2. Bars 5–6 fall by step to F on the downbeat of bar 6, with no C#: a cadence in F major, the relative major.
3. Bar 7 climbs to the high point (E4) and brings back C# to return to D minor.
4. Bar 8 ends on D, the tonic.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (*Andante espressivo*), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the cello.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4. Q4 · 3m **D: 5th.** The chord at X is I (E–G–B). The Violin I plays B, the 5th.
5. Q4 · 3m **B: Eb.** In alto clef, middle C is the middle line. Y is Eb.
6. Q4 · 3m **D: V7.** C# with "7 #" is V7: C#–E#–G#–B.
7. Q4 · 3m **B: imperfect.** The last two chords are Ib and V: ending on V is an imperfect cadence.
8. Q4 · 3m **C: changing notes.** Changing notes are a pair: one above and one below the chord note, before returning to it.
9. Q4 · 3m **C: perfect 15th.** B up to B is a perfect 15th (a compound perfect unison: 15 letters counting both ends).
10. Q4 · 3m **D: C major.** The subdominant key is built on note 4: C major.
11. Q4 · 4m **B: it gets quieter (mf to pp).** It starts mf and changes to pp at D.
12. Q5 · 3m **B: it's a Bb instrument, so it's written a tone higher.** The music sounds in Bb major, so the Bb clarinet is written a tone higher, in C major.

13. Q5 · 3m **D: G**. A B $\flat$ clarinet sounds a major 2nd (a tone) lower than written: written A sounds as G, the same note as violin II.
14. Q5 · 3m **D: F**. A B $\flat$ clarinet sounds a major 2nd (a tone) lower than written: written G sounds as F, the same note as violin II.
15. Q5 · 3m **D: a major 2nd lower**. The trumpet in B $\flat$ sounds a major 2nd lower than written.
16. Q5 · 3m **B: F**. The horn in F sounds a perfect 5th lower than written, so go DOWN a perfect 5th: C sounds as F.
17. Q5 · 3m **A: swiftly**. veloce is Italian for "swiftly".
18. Q5 · 3m **B: 3rd**. The chord at X is VI (D-F $\sharp$ -A). The Violin II plays F $\sharp$, the 3rd.
19. Q5 · 4m **B: auxiliary note**. An auxiliary note steps away from a chord note and comes straight back to it.

Grade 6 practice paper 4

Time allowed: 3 hours · 100 marks · pass 66, merit 80, distinction 90

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 100

Our own paper in the style of the ABRSM Grade 6 exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Suggested timing: questions 1 and 2, 25 minutes each (in question 1 you may write in four parts or keyboard style; this paper practises four parts); question 3, 35 minutes; questions 4 and 5, 35 minutes each; 25 minutes to check.

Question 1: Figured bass (15 marks)

15 marks

1. Realise this figured bass: add soprano, alto and tenor. (E major)

6/5 7

Question 2: Chords for a melody (15 marks)

15 marks

2. This melody modulates from D major to A major. Choose a chord for each beat, ending with a perfect cadence in the new key. From note 5, name the chords in A major.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8

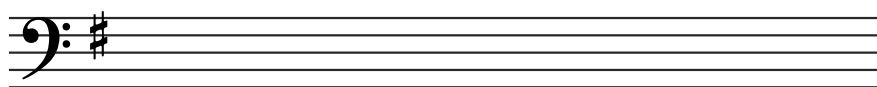
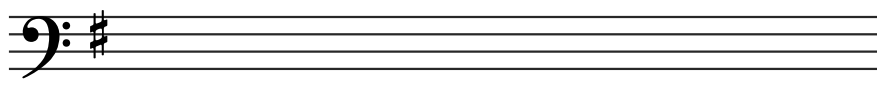
Chords: 1 ____ 2 ____ 3 ____ 4 ____ 5 ____ 6 ____ 7 ____ 8 ____

Or write a bass line with figures on the stave above.

Question 3: Composition (20 marks)

20 marks

3. Composition: Continue this opening for cello to make a melody of 8 bars. It should modulate to the dominant (D major), then return to G major. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance directions.



cello range: C2 upwards (tenor clef for high notes).

Question 4: Questions on a score (25 marks)

3 marks

4. Name the interval between the cello and violin I at X (the first note of violin I there).

Andantino

A. major 17th

B. diminished 17th

C. diminished 18th

D. augmented 18th

3 marks

5. This string quartet extract is in G major. Name the chord at X.

Andante



A. IVc

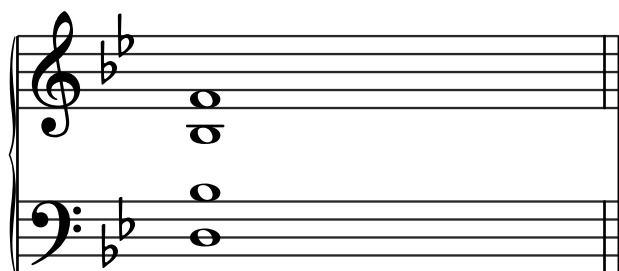
B. VI

C. IIb

D. Ib

3 marks

6. Which figures go under this chord? (Key: B $\flat$ major)



A. 6/4

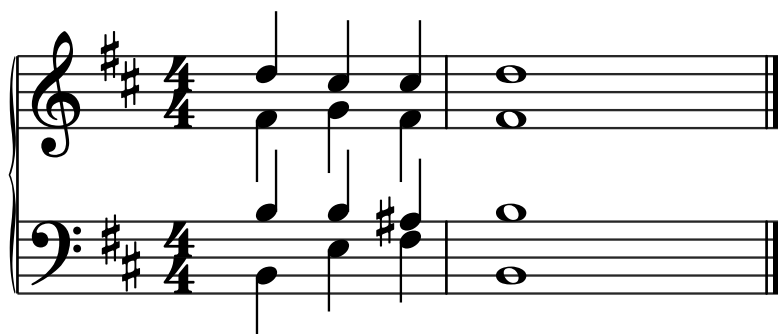
B. 6

C. 4/3

D. 7

3 marks

7. Name the cadence at the end of this passage in B minor.



A. plagal

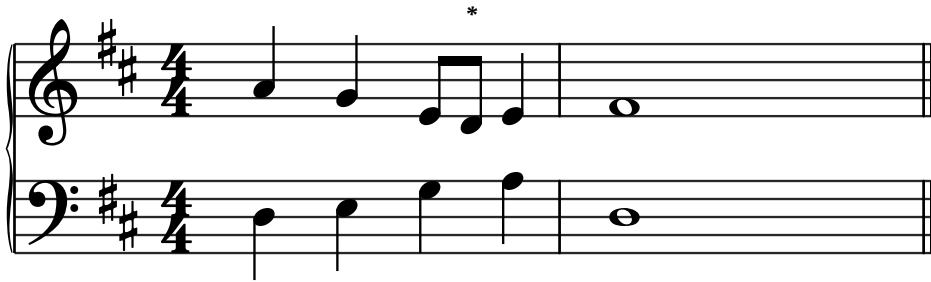
B. perfect

C. interrupted

D. imperfect

3 marks

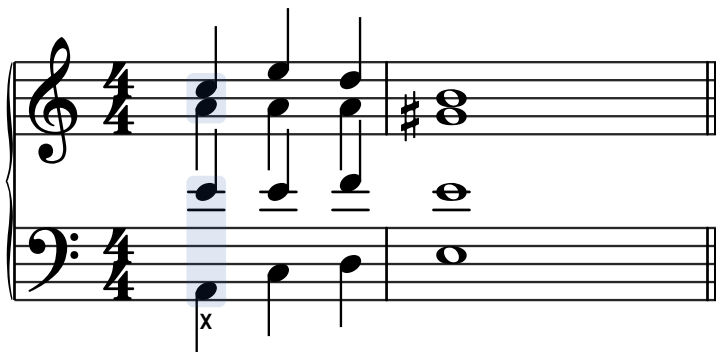
8. The note marked * is which kind of note? (D major)



- A. passing note B. anticipation C. auxiliary note D. suspension

3 marks

9. Name the interval between the bass and alto in the chord marked X.



- A. augmented 15th B. augmented 16th C. perfect 15th D. diminished 14th

3 marks

10. What is the dominant key of B minor?

- A. F# minor B. C# minor C. A major D. G minor

4 marks

11. Which device does this extract use? (A major)



- A. imitation B. a falling sequence C. a rising sequence D. a dominant pedal

Question 5: An orchestral score and general questions (25 marks)

3 marks

12. The clarinet in B $\flat$ plays the note marked X. Which note actually sounds?

The musical score consists of eight staves, each for a different instrument. All staves are in 4/4 time and the key of D major (two sharps: F# and C#). The instruments and their parts are as follows:

- Flute:** Treble clef. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (half).
- Clarinet in B $\flat$:** Treble clef. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (half). The note G4 is marked with an 'X'.
- Horn in F:** Treble clef. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (half).
- Bassoon:** Bass clef. Notes: D3 (quarter), E3 (quarter), F#3 (quarter), G3 (quarter), A3 (half).
- Violin I:** Treble clef. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (half).
- Violin II:** Treble clef. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (half).
- Viola:** Alto clef. Notes: D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), A4 (half).
- Cello:** Bass clef. Notes: D3 (quarter), E3 (quarter), F#3 (quarter), G3 (quarter), A3 (half).

A. E

B. B

C. C $\sharp$

D. D

3 marks

13. The clarinet in B $\flat$ plays the note marked X. Which note actually sounds?

The musical score is for a woodwind and string ensemble in 4/4 time, key of B $\flat$ major. The instruments are Flute, Clarinet in B $\flat$, Horn in F, Bassoon, Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. The Clarinet in B $\flat$ part has a note marked with an 'X' on the fifth line of the staff, which is a whole note. The other instruments play a similar melodic line in the first four measures, ending with a whole note in the fifth measure.

Instrument	Measure 1	Measure 2	Measure 3	Measure 4	Measure 5
Flute	G $\flat$ 4	A4	B $\flat$ 4	C5	D5
Clarinet in B $\flat$	G $\flat$ 4	A4	B $\flat$ 4	C5	D5 (X)
Horn in F	G $\flat$ 4	A4	B $\flat$ 4	C5	D5
Bassoon	G $\flat$ 4	A4	B $\flat$ 4	C5	D5
Violin I	G $\flat$ 4	A4	B $\flat$ 4	C5	D5
Violin II	G $\flat$ 4	A4	B $\flat$ 4	C5	D5
Viola	G $\flat$ 4	A4	B $\flat$ 4	C5	D5
Cello	G $\flat$ 4	A4	B $\flat$ 4	C5	D5

A. D

B. F

C. A

D. G

3 marks

14. The clarinet in B $\flat$ plays the note marked X. Which note actually sounds?

The musical score shows eight staves for the following instruments: Flute, Clarinet in B $\flat$, Horn in F, Bassoon, Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. All instruments are in 4/4 time and the key of B $\flat$ major. The Clarinet in B $\flat$ staff has a note marked with an 'X' on the line below the staff, which is a B $\flat$ note (Bb4).

A. G

B. B $\flat$

C. A

D. F

3 marks

15. In a full orchestral score, which of these is written lower down the page?

A. tuba

B. violin I

3 marks

16. This is the sound you want from the clarinet in B $\flat$. Which note must be written for it?

A musical staff in treble clef showing a whole note on the second line, which is the note G4.

A. A

B. F

C. G

D. G $\sharp$

3 marks

17. Which German word means "peaceful"?

A. con brio

B. animato

C. ruhig

D. perdendosi

3 marks

18. How does the dynamic change at D?

Maestoso

The musical score is for four instruments: Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. The key signature is one flat (B-flat) and the time signature is 4/4. The tempo/mood is marked 'Maestoso'. The score consists of two measures. In the first measure, all instruments play a half note. Violin I and Violin II start with a forte (*f*) dynamic. Viola and Cello are marked 'pizz.' (pizzicato). In the second measure, all instruments play a half note. Violin I and Violin II have a trill (*tr*) over the note and a dynamic change to mezzo-forte (*mf*). Viola and Cello are marked 'arco' (arco) and also change to *mf*. The letter 'D' is written above the second measure, indicating the point of dynamic change.

- A. it stays the same B. it gets quieter (*f* to *mf*) C. it gets louder (*f* to *mf*) D. it gradually gets louder

4 marks

19. The note marked * is which kind of note? (A major)

The musical score is for piano in A major (two sharps: F# and C#) and 4/4 time. It consists of two staves. The treble staff has a note marked with an asterisk (*) in the second measure, which is a half note. The bass staff has a half note in the first measure and a whole note in the second measure.

- A. appoggiatura B. auxiliary note C. suspension D. anticipation

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. Q1 · 15m **Model answer below (other good answers are possible): I - II7b - V - I - IV - V7 - I.**

I II7b V I IV V7 I

Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each real mistake (a wrong chord or note, a missing 3rd, consecutive 5ths or octaves, a doubled leading note, an unresolved 7th or leading note). Take off 1 for weaker points (an awkward leap, a doubled 3rd).

2. Q2 · 15m **One good answer: I - IV - V - I - A: II - Ic - V - I.**

I IV V I A: II Ic V I

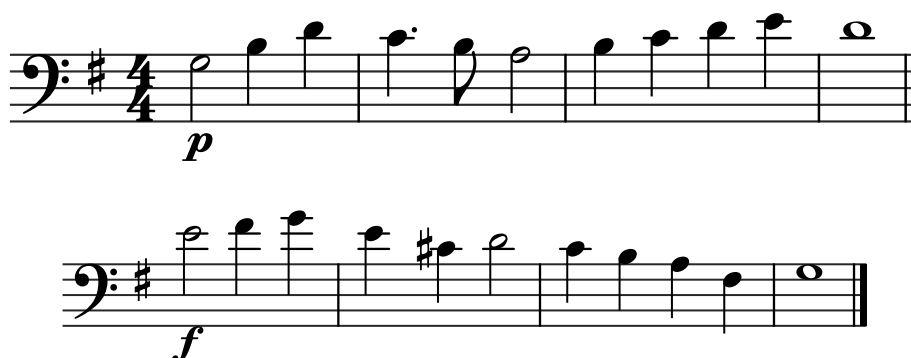
Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each real mistake (a wrong chord or note, a missing 3rd, consecutive 5ths or octaves, a doubled leading note, an unresolved 7th or leading note). Take off 1 for weaker points (an awkward leap, a doubled 3rd).

3. Q3 · 20m **Mark with the checklist (10 points × 2 marks).**

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps
6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

One model answer:

Andante



1. Bars 3–4 climb by step to D, the dominant, held for a bar.
2. Bars 5–6 reach the high point (G4) and use C#: a cadence in D major, the dominant.
3. Bar 7 brings back C# and walks down to the leading note F#.
4. Bar 8: G, the tonic.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (Andante), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the cello.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4. Q4 · 3m **A: major 17th.** Cello F# up to violin I A#: a major 17th.
5. Q4 · 3m **D: lb.** At X the four instruments play B, D, G, G (cello upwards): G–B–D with B in the bass, so lb.
6. Q4 · 3m **B: 6.** The chord is lb (Bb–D–F) with D in the bass. Count up from the bass: 6.
7. Q4 · 3m **B: perfect.** The last two chords are V and I: V–I is a perfect cadence.
8. Q4 · 3m **C: auxiliary note.** An auxiliary note steps away from a chord note and comes straight back to it.
9. Q4 · 3m **C: perfect 15th.** A up to A is a perfect 15th (a compound perfect unison: 15 letters counting both ends).
10. Q4 · 3m **A: F# minor.** The dominant key is built on note 5: F# minor.
11. Q4 · 4m **C: a rising sequence.** The same shape is repeated, starting a step higher each time.
12. Q5 · 3m **D: D.** A Bb clarinet sounds a major 2nd (a tone) lower than written: written E sounds as D, the same note as violin II.
13. Q5 · 3m **B: F.** A Bb clarinet sounds a major 2nd (a tone) lower than written: written G sounds as F, the same note as violin II.

14. Q5 · 3m **A: G**. A B $\flat$ clarinet sounds a major 2nd (a tone) lower than written: written A sounds as G, the same note as violin II.
15. Q5 · 3m **B: violin I**. Score order from the top: woodwind (flute, oboe, clarinet, bassoon), brass (horn, trumpet, trombone, tuba), percussion (timpani first), then strings (violin I, violin II, viola, cello, double bass). So tuba comes above violin I.
16. Q5 · 3m **C: G**. The clarinet in B $\flat$ sounds a major 2nd lower than written, so write it UP a major 2nd: F is written as G.
17. Q5 · 3m **C: ruhig**. ruhig is German for "peaceful".
18. Q5 · 3m **B: it gets quieter (f to mf)**. It starts f and changes to mf at D.
19. Q5 · 4m **D: anticipation**. An anticipation sounds a note of the NEXT chord early, before the chord changes.

Grade 6 practice paper 5

Time allowed: 3 hours · 100 marks · pass 66, merit 80, distinction 90

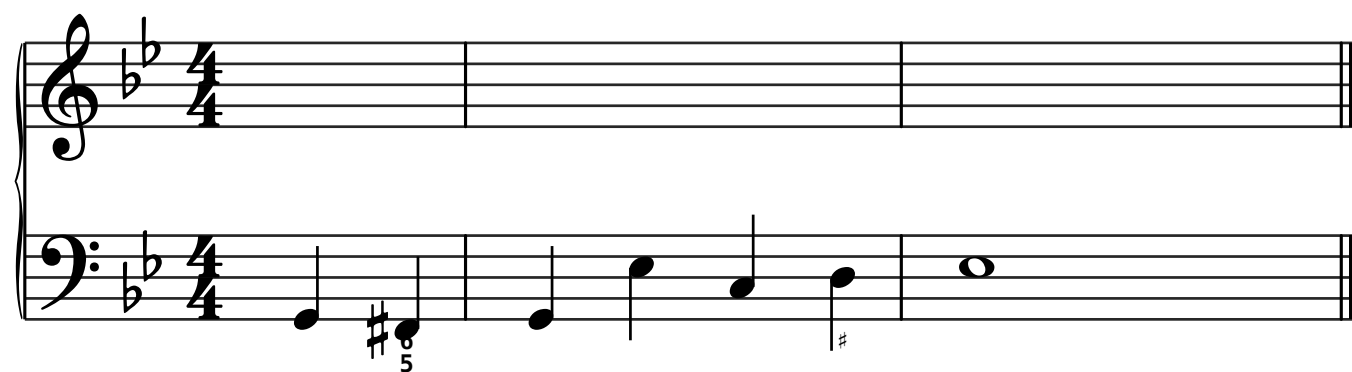
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 100

Our own paper in the style of the ABRSM Grade 6 exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Suggested timing: questions 1 and 2, 25 minutes each (in question 1 you may write in four parts or keyboard style; this paper practises keyboard style); question 3, 35 minutes; questions 4 and 5, 35 minutes each; 25 minutes to check.

Question 1: Figured bass (15 marks)

15 marks

1. Realise this figured bass in keyboard style: three notes in the right hand on the treble stave, the given bass alone in the left hand. (G minor)



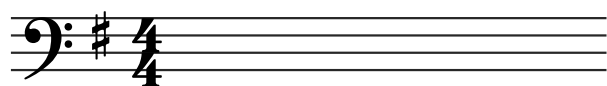
Question 2: Chords for a melody (15 marks)

15 marks

2. Choose a chord for each beat, ending with a perfect cadence. (G major)



Chords: 1 ____ 2 ____ 3 ____ 4 ____ 5 ____ 6 ____ 7 ____ 8 ____

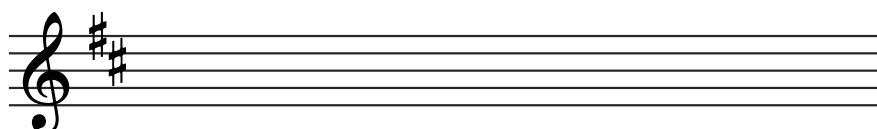
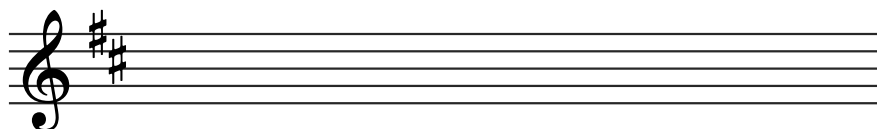


Or write a bass line with figures on the stave above.

Question 3: Composition (20 marks)

20 marks

3. Composition: Continue this opening for violin to make a melody of 8 bars. It should modulate to the dominant (A major), then return to D major. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance directions.



violin range: G3 upwards (comfortably up to about E6).

Question 4: Questions on a score (25 marks)

3 marks

4. This string quartet extract is in E major. Name the chord at X.

Maestoso

A. IV

B. VI

C. V7c

D. V7

3 marks

5. What does the tempo marking "Andante con moto" mean?

Andante con moto

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

- A. moderately fast B. fast, but not too fast C. at a walking pace, with movement D. slow

3 marks

6. This passage is in A major. Name the chord marked X.

X

- A. VI B. I C. IVc D. V

3 marks

7. Name the cadence at the end of this passage in F# minor.

- A. perfect B. plagal C. imperfect D. interrupted

3 marks

8. The two notes marked * are which kind of note? (C major)



A. appoggiatura

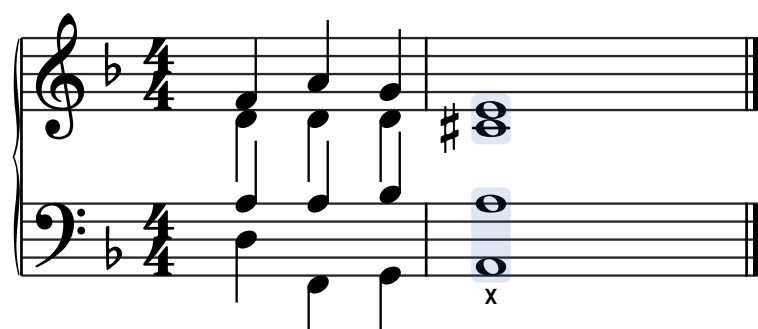
B. changing notes

C. anticipation

D. suspension

3 marks

9. Name the interval between the bass and soprano in the chord marked X.



A. augmented 13th

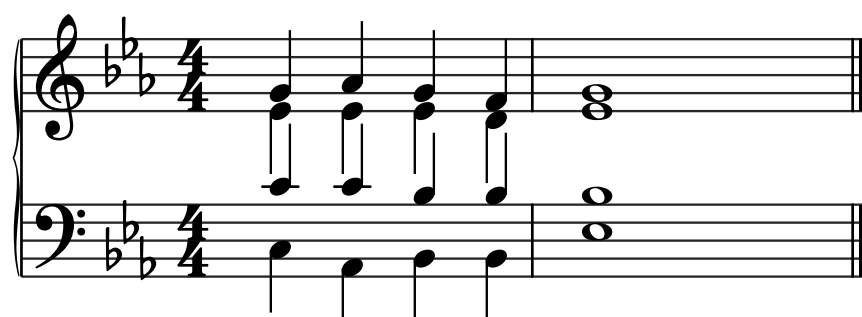
B. perfect 12th

C. diminished 11th

D. augmented 12th

3 marks

10. This passage starts in C minor. Which key does it end in?



A. C minor

B. G minor

C. Eb major

D. F minor

11. What is the bass part doing? (E^b major)

A musical score for the song 'The Rose Tree'. It features a treble and bass staff in 4/4 time, with a key signature of two flats (B-flat and E-flat). The melody is written in the treble staff, and the accompaniment is in the bass staff. The melody consists of a series of eighth and quarter notes, while the accompaniment features a steady eighth-note pattern.

- ### Question 5: An orchestral score and general questions (25 marks)

12. Which instruments play the bass line together?

The first system of the musical score includes parts for Flute, Clarinet in B $\flat$, Horn in F, Bassoon, Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. The Flute part begins with a whole rest, while the other instruments play a descending eighth-note scale (G $\flat$, F $\flat$, E $\flat$, D $\flat$) followed by a whole note G $\flat$ in the second measure.

- A. clarinet and bassoon B. bassoon and cello C. viola and cello D. bassoon and viola

3 marks

13. Which note actually sounds for the horn in F at Y?

The musical score is for an orchestra in 4/4 time with a key signature of one flat (Bb). The instruments listed are Flute, Clarinet in Bb, Horn in F, Bassoon, Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. The Horn in F part is the focus of the question. The note marked 'Y' is a Bb in the staff's key signature.

A. D

B. G

C. A

D. Bb

3 marks

14. Which note actually sounds for the horn in F at Y?

A. D

B. B

C. A

D. G

3 marks

15. This is the sound you want from the trumpet in B $\flat$. Which note must be written for it?

A. F

B. G

C. G $\flat$

D. A

3 marks

16. How does the clarinet in B $\flat$ sound, compared with its written notes?

A. an octave higher

B. a perfect 5th lower

C. an octave lower

D. a major 2nd lower

3 marks

17. What does this mean?

arco

A. with the bow

B. bow over the fingerboard

C. at choice, freely

D. loud

3 marks

18. Name the viola's note at Y. (The viola reads alto clef.)

Moderato

The musical score is for a piece in D minor, 4/4 time, marked Moderato. It features four staves: Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. The key signature has two flats (Bb and Eb). The time signature is 4/4. The dynamics are *p* (piano) and *pp* (pianissimo). The Viola part is written in alto clef. The note marked 'Y' is a half note on the second line of the Viola staff, which is Bb.

A. C

B. B $\flat$

C. E $\flat$

D. D $\flat$

4 marks

19. The note marked * is which kind of note? (D minor)

The musical score is for a single instrument in D minor, 4/4 time. The key signature has two flats (Bb and Eb). The time signature is 4/4. The note marked * is a half note on the second line of the treble staff, which is Bb.

A. suspension

B. passing note

C. anticipation

D. auxiliary note

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. Q1 · 15m **Model answer below (other good answers are possible): I - V7b - I - VI - IV - V - VI.**

I V7b I VI IV V VI

Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each real mistake (a wrong chord or note, a missing 3rd, consecutive 5ths or octaves, a doubled leading note, an unresolved 7th or leading note). Take off 1 for weaker points (an awkward leap, a doubled 3rd).

2. Q2 · 15m **One good answer: I - Vb - I - II7b - Ic - V7 - I.**

I Vb I II7b Ic V7 I

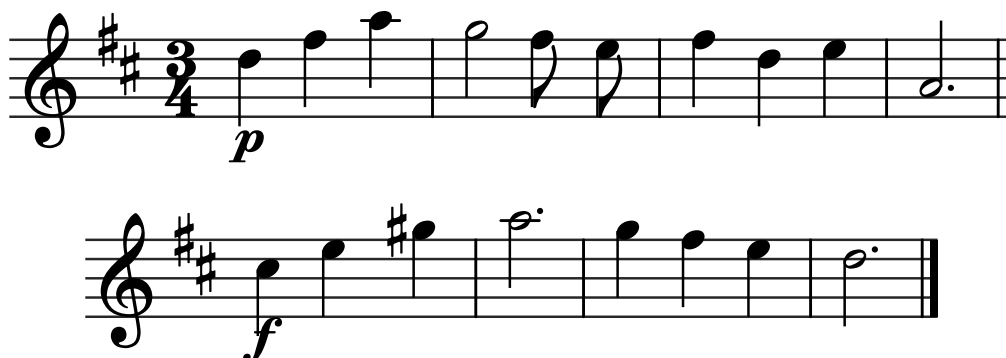
Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each real mistake (a wrong chord or note, a missing 3rd, consecutive 5ths or octaves, a doubled leading note, an unresolved 7th or leading note). Take off 1 for weaker points (an awkward leap, a doubled 3rd).

3. Q3 · 20m **Mark with the checklist (10 points × 2 marks).**

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps
6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

One model answer:

Allegretto



1. Bars 3–4 answer the opening and stop on A, the dominant: an imperfect cadence.
2. Bar 5 climbs through C# and E to G#, the leading note of A major; bar 6 lands on A, the high point, on the downbeat: a cadence in the dominant.
3. Bar 7 brings back G#, which takes us home to D major.
4. Bar 8 ends on the tonic, D, on the first beat.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (*Allegretto*), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the violin.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4. Q4 · 3m **D: V7**. At X the four instruments play B, A, D#, F# (cello upwards): B–D#–F#–A with B in the bass, so V7.
5. Q4 · 3m **C: at a walking pace, with movement**. Andante con moto: at a walking pace, with movement.
6. Q4 · 3m **B: I**. X is A–C#–E with A in the bass: I (root position).
7. Q4 · 3m **A: perfect**. The last two chords are V and I: V–I is a perfect cadence.
8. Q4 · 3m **B: changing notes**. Changing notes are a pair: one above and one below the chord note, before returning to it.
9. Q4 · 3m **B: perfect 12th**. A up to E is a perfect 12th (a compound perfect 5th: 12 letters counting both ends).
10. Q4 · 3m **C: Eb major**. It ends with a perfect cadence in Eb major: Bb–D–F then Eb–G–Bb. Look for the new accidental: D is the new key's leading note.
11. Q4 · 4m **C: an Alberti bass**. The left hand breaks each chord into the pattern low–high–middle–high.
12. Q5 · 3m **B: bassoon and cello**. The bassoon and cello have the same notes: the bass line.

13. Q5 · 3m **B: G**. A horn in F sounds a perfect 5th lower than written (horn parts are often written without a key signature). Its written note at Y sounds as G, the same note the viola has.
14. Q5 · 3m **B: B**. A horn in F sounds a perfect 5th lower than written (horn parts are often written without a key signature). Its written note at Y sounds as B, the same note the viola has.
15. Q5 · 3m **B: G**. The trumpet in B $\flat$ sounds a major 2nd lower than written, so write it UP a major 2nd: F is written as G.
16. Q5 · 3m **D: a major 2nd lower**. The clarinet in B $\flat$ sounds a major 2nd lower than written.
17. Q5 · 3m **A: with the bow**. arco is Italian for "with the bow".
18. Q5 · 3m **D: D $\flat$** . In alto clef, middle C is the middle line. Y is D $\flat$.
19. Q5 · 4m **D: auxiliary note**. An auxiliary note steps away from a chord note and comes straight back to it.

Grade 6 practice paper 6

Time allowed: 3 hours · 100 marks · pass 66, merit 80, distinction 90

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 100

Our own paper in the style of the ABRSM Grade 6 exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Suggested timing: questions 1 and 2, 25 minutes each (in question 1 you may write in four parts or keyboard style; this paper practises keyboard style); question 3, 35 minutes; questions 4 and 5, 35 minutes each; 25 minutes to check.

Question 1: Figured bass (15 marks)

15 marks

1. Realise this figured bass in keyboard style: three notes in the right hand on the treble stave, the given bass alone in the left hand. (B $\flat$ major)



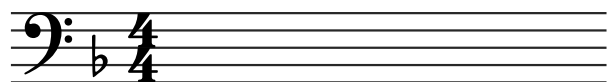
Question 2: Chords for a melody (15 marks)

15 marks

2. This melody modulates from F major to C major. Choose a chord for each beat, ending with a perfect cadence in the new key. From note 4, name the chords in C major.



Chords: 1 ____ 2 ____ 3 ____ 4 ____ 5 ____ 6 ____ 7 ____ 8 ____

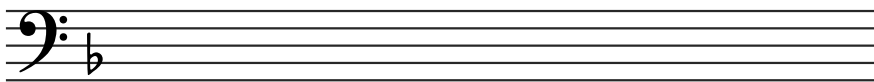
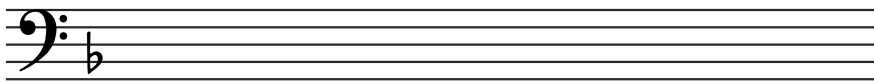


Or write a bass line with figures on the stave above.

Question 3: Composition (20 marks)

20 marks

3. Composition: Continue this opening for cello to make a melody of 8 bars. It may modulate to the relative major (F major) or the dominant minor (A minor), then return to D minor. Add a tempo marking, dynamics, phrasing and other performance directions.



cello range: C2 upwards (tenor clef for high notes).

Question 4: Questions on a score (25 marks)

3 marks

4. The note marked * in violin I is which kind of note?

Grazioso

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

A. anticipation

B. auxiliary note

C. suspension

D. changing note

3 marks

5. This string quartet extract is in A minor. Name the chord at X.

Andantino

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

A. V7b

B. IVb

C. Ib

D. II7b

3 marks

6. This passage is in F# minor. Name the chord marked X.

X

A. VIIb

B. Vc

C. V7b

D. II7b

3 marks

7. Name the cadence at the end of this passage in C major.

X

A. plagal

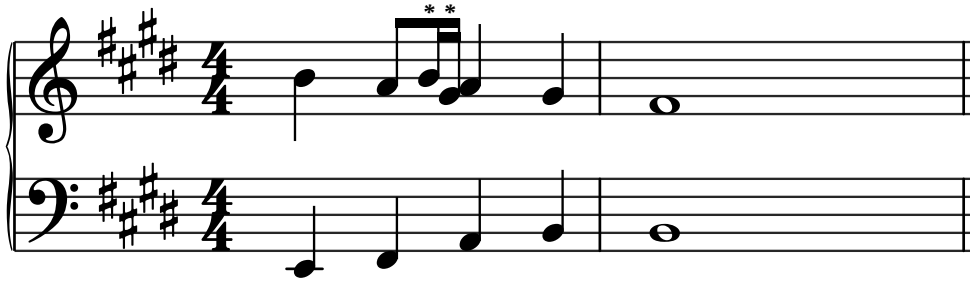
B. imperfect

C. perfect

D. interrupted

3 marks

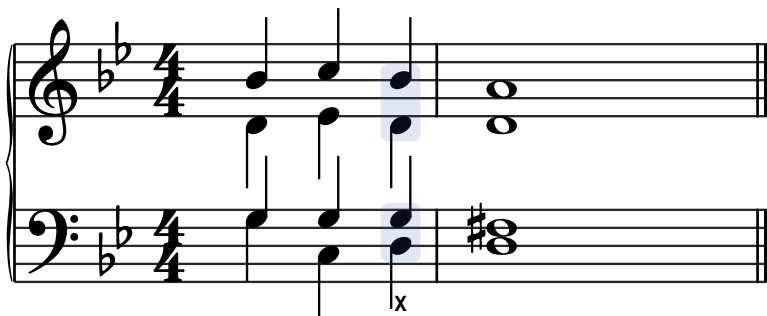
8. The two notes marked * are which kind of note? (E major)



- A. auxiliary note B. changing notes C. appoggiatura D. passing note

3 marks

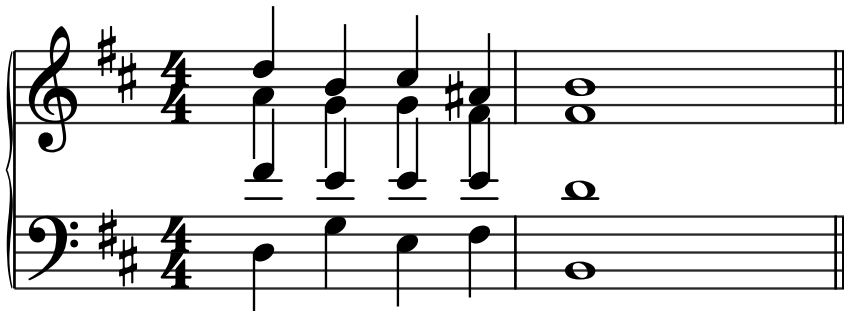
9. Name the interval between the tenor and soprano in the chord marked X.



- A. augmented 11th B. major 10th C. minor 9th D. minor 10th

3 marks

10. This passage starts in D major. Which key does it end in?



- A. G major B. D major C. A major D. B minor

4 marks

11. Which rhythmic device is used in bars 2-3? (A major)



- A. repetition B. a rising sequence C. augmentation D. a hemiola

Question 5: An orchestral score and general questions (25 marks)

3 marks

12. Which instruments play the bass line together?

The musical score is for an orchestra in D major (two sharps) and 4/4 time. The instruments listed on the left are Flute, Clarinet in B $\flat$, Horn in F, Bassoon, Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. The bass line is played by the Bassoon, Viola, and Cello. The melody is played by the Flute, Clarinet in B $\flat$, Horn in F, Violin I, Violin II, and Viola. The bass line consists of a series of eighth notes: D2, E2, F2, G2, A2, B2, C3, and a final half note D2.

A. bassoon and cello

B. viola and cello

C. clarinet and bassoon

D. horn and cello

3 marks

13. Which instruments play the bass line together?

The musical score is for an orchestra in 4/4 time. The instruments listed are Flute, Clarinet in B $\flat$, Horn in F, Bassoon, Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello. The bass line is played by the Bassoon and Cello.

The bass line consists of the following notes: G 2 (quarter), F 2 (quarter), E 2 (quarter), D 2 (quarter), and C 2 (half).

A. horn and cello

B. clarinet and bassoon

C. viola and cello

D. bassoon and cello

3 marks

14. Why does the clarinet part have a different key signature from the strings?

The musical score shows eight staves for an orchestra. The key signature is D major (two sharps) for most instruments. The Clarinet in Bb part is written in the alto clef and has a key signature of three sharps (F# major). The Horn in F part has a key signature of one sharp (D major). The Flute, Violin I, Violin II, Viola, and Cello parts all have a key signature of two sharps (D major).

- A. it sounds a tone higher than written B. it plays in a different key on purpose C. it's a B $\flat$ instrument, so it's written a tone higher D. the clarinet reads alto clef

3 marks

15. In a full orchestral score, which of these is written higher up the page?

- A. oboe B. flute

3 marks

16. In a full orchestral score, which of these is written higher up the page?

- A. violin II B. tuba

3 marks

17. What does this mean?

lento

- A. loud, then immediately quiet B. slow C. animated, lively D. dying away

3 marks

18. What does "pizz." in the cello part tell the player, and what cancels it?

Lento

Violin I

Violin II

Viola

Cello

- A. play near the bridge; ord. cancels it
- B. play with a mute; senza C. use the bow; pizz. cancels it
- D. pluck the strings; arco means use the bow again

4 marks

19. The note marked * is which kind of note? (D minor)

- A. suspension
- B. auxiliary note
- C. appoggiatura
- D. changing notes

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. Q1 · 15m **Model answer below (other good answers are possible): I - VI - II - V - V7 - I - V7 - VI.**

I VI II V V7 I V7 VI

Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each real mistake (a wrong chord or note, a missing 3rd, consecutive 5ths or octaves, a doubled leading note, an unresolved 7th or leading note). Take off 1 for weaker points (an awkward leap, a doubled 3rd).

2. Q2 · 15m **One good answer: I - V - V7 - C: IV - Ic - V - I.**

I V V7 C: IV Ic V I

Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each real mistake (a wrong chord or note, a missing 3rd, consecutive 5ths or octaves, a doubled leading note, an unresolved 7th or leading note). Take off 1 for weaker points (an awkward leap, a doubled 3rd).

3. Q3 · 20m **Mark with the checklist (10 points × 2 marks).**

1. 8 bars, and every bar adds up to the time signature
2. Two balanced phrases, with a clear cadence at bar 4
3. The opening's rhythm or shape comes back (repeat, sequence or a variation)
4. It modulates clearly (a new accidental, or in a minor key cancelling the raised 7th to reach the relative major) and comes back home
5. A clear high point, and a good shape: mostly steps with some leaps
6. It ends on the tonic, on a strong beat
7. It stays in the instrument's range and suits the instrument
8. A tempo marking (an Italian term is fine)
9. Dynamics, including at least one change
10. Phrasing slurs and some articulation (staccato, accents, tenuto)

One model answer:

Andante espressivo



1. Bars 3–4 rise to C#, the leading note, held over chord V: an imperfect cadence.
2. Bars 5–6 fall by step to F on the downbeat of bar 6, with no C#: a cadence in F major, the relative major.
3. Bar 7 climbs to the high point (E4) and brings back C# to return to D minor.
4. Bar 8 ends on D, the tonic.
5. Performance directions: a tempo word (*Andante espressivo*), a quiet start, a crescendo to the high point, slurs over each phrase, and some staccato or accents where they suit the cello.

This is one good answer, not the only one. Compare yours: is the plan the same even if the notes are different?

4. Q4 · 3m **B: auxiliary note.** It steps away from a chord note and comes straight back.
5. Q4 · 3m **D: II7b.** At X the four instruments play D, A, F, B (cello upwards): B–D–F–A with D in the bass, so II7b.
6. Q4 · 3m **C: V7b.** X is C#–E#–G#–B with E# in the bass: V7b (first inversion).
7. Q4 · 3m **D: interrupted.** The last two chords are V and VI: V–VI is an interrupted cadence.
8. Q4 · 3m **B: changing notes.** Changing notes are a pair: one above and one below the chord note, before returning to it.
9. Q4 · 3m **D: minor 10th.** G up to Bb is a minor 10th (a compound minor 3rd: 10 letters counting both ends).
10. Q4 · 3m **D: B minor.** It ends with a perfect cadence in B minor: F#–A#–C#–E then B–D–F#. Look for the new accidental: A# is the new key's leading note.
11. Q4 · 4m **D: a hemiola.** In 3/4, two bars are grouped as if they were three bars of 2/4: three minims across two bars, usually just before a cadence.
12. Q5 · 3m **A: bassoon and cello.** The bassoon and cello have the same notes: the bass line.

13. Q5 · 3m **D: bassoon and cello.** The bassoon and cello have the same notes: the bass line.
14. Q5 · 3m **C: it's a B $\flat$ instrument, so it's written a tone higher.** The music sounds in D major, so the B $\flat$ clarinet is written a tone higher, in E major.
15. Q5 · 3m **B: flute.** Score order from the top: woodwind (flute, oboe, clarinet, bassoon), brass (horn, trumpet, trombone, tuba), percussion (timpani first), then strings (violin I, violin II, viola, cello, double bass). So flute comes above oboe.
16. Q5 · 3m **B: tuba.** Score order from the top: woodwind (flute, oboe, clarinet, bassoon), brass (horn, trumpet, trombone, tuba), percussion (timpani first), then strings (violin I, violin II, viola, cello, double bass). So tuba comes above violin II.
17. Q5 · 3m **B: slow.** *lento* is Italian for "slow".
18. Q5 · 3m **D: pluck the strings; arco means use the bow again.** pizz. (pizzicato): pluck. arco: back to the bow.
19. Q5 · 4m **C: appoggiatura.** An appoggiatura leans on the beat: it's a clash on the strong part of the beat that then falls (or rises) by step to the chord note.